

History

U.S.





About the Course

Read United States history stories from the current history cycle (1800-1900). View images and reference atlases and maps to set the people and events in their time and place. Update History Charts as appropriate for student level.



Placement & Combining Tips

History courses are on a four-year rotation. Students should follow the current Alveary rotation.



Scheduling

GRADE	SCHEDULE INFO.	BOOKS
2-3	History: Grades 2-3 (U.S.) 1 time/week 20 min	Escape by Night: A Civil War Adventure Dandelions Buffalo Bird Girl: A Hidatsa Story Coolies Abraham Lincoln: An Initial Biography United States Atlas 7th Ed.

Sample Weekly View

Day 1	Day 2	Day 3	Day 4	Day 5
History: Grades 2-3 (U.S.)				
				History: Grades 2-3 (U.S.)



Planning & Prep

Permission to print for non-commercial use. See Alveary group use policy to use lessons in a group context.

LINKS: Click text or scan the QR code in the top corner of the lesson plan pages to view online resources associated with the lessons.

Responsibility for previewing all links rests with the teacher. All links were checked at the time of publication; however, websites change frequently and may contain objectionable content. Please report broken links by contacting us through our website.



Books & Resources

For book rationales and purchase options, click the Book List link or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Book List Details](#)

History: Grades 2-3 (U.S.)



Escape by Night: A Civil War Adventure



Dandelions



Buffalo Bird Girl: A Hidatsa Story



Coolies



Abraham Lincoln: An Initial Biography



United States Atlas 7th Ed.



Supplies

For supply list details and basic supplies helpful to have on hand, click the links or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Basic Supplies](#)
(No Subject Supplies Assigned)



Quick Links

History: Grades 2-3 (U.S.)

- ∞ [Extra Helpings](#)
- ∞ [Foundations \(See Section 15: History\)](#)
- ∞ [History Charts & Timeline Scope & Sample](#)

Click THIS text
or scan the QR
code for links.



History: Grades 2-3 (U.S.)

How To Teach



Prepare

- Read through the lesson and gather any materials or find any necessary links.
- If you have not already read the book, you may want to read the selected pages in advance.



Recap

- Connect to previous lessons by asking students to recall where they left off.
- If students have difficulty recalling, teachers might try showing them a picture from the reading, sharing something the teacher remembers, or prompting them with the first sentence of the last reading. This will often refresh their memory enough to allow them to recall.
- If students still cannot recall anything from the last reading, teachers might consider continuing anyway (with a shorter reading this time) or repeating the previous lesson, depending on the reading and the nature of the book.



Introduce

- Use a picture, map, or engaging question to pique the student's interest in the day's lesson.
- If necessary, you may talk about one or two unfamiliar words that will be crucial to understanding.



Read

- Read the day's passage out loud. When reading to pre-readers, point to the words as you read, even if it seems like they aren't paying attention.
- Move at the student's pace for the lesson time rather than a particular number of pages. It is vitally important that teachers not try to 'force feed' a student more than they can consume in one sitting.
- Students who have a difficult time sitting still or listening may benefit from a fidget of their choice, such as a piece of putty or clay or an afghan; flexible positioning, such as a wobble seat or inverted sitting; or sensory modulation, such as a weighted vest or blanket or adjustment of light, temperature, or sound.



Narrate

- Have students retell the passage orally.
- Alternatively, learners may use words, pictures, Legos, dolls, etc., to process and convey ideas in the manner most natural to them.
- Teachers may take turns to model.
- Narration is a complex skill requiring the coordination of several parts of the brain. If a student struggles to narrate in general, with a specific subject or book, or on one day but not others, then this is an opportunity to learn. Observe when they struggle with this or any other activity today. Notice facial expressions and body language; listen to what they say about why it is hard or how they feel about it. Take note of these observations for later, tell them that you see how hard they

are working, and then offer whatever support they need to end on a positive note. If necessary, take a break for the day.



Discuss

- Give the student an opportunity to share thoughts on the lesson and any connections made.
- To stimulate discussion, you could ask them what they thought about the passage or ask an open-ended question.

History: Grades 2-3 (U.S.)

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Term 1

WEEK 1 20m History: Grades 2-3 (U.S.) - Lesson 1

Kentucky

Materials: Abraham Lincoln: An Initial Biography, U.S. Atlas

→ INTRO

Have you heard the name Abraham Lincoln? What do you know about him? He was the 16th President of the United States. However, no one would have assumed a boy born in a log cabin and who barely went to school would grow up to become the President. This is the story of his life.

→ VIEW

∞ Image Link: Replica of log cabin

This is a replica, or copy, of the one-room log cabin where Abraham Lincoln was born. What would be hard about living there with your family? You can see the inside of a cabin in your book.

→ LOCATE

Map Resource: U.S. Atlas p.14-15

Find Kentucky. This is where Abraham Lincoln was born.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.5-14 "It was a" - "was only seven."

- How is Abraham's life different from yours?
- How was life harder back then in the 1800s?

→ VIEW

∞ Image Link: Photograph of Abraham Lincoln

You can use this for your wall timeline.

WEEK 2 20m History: Grades 2-3 (U.S.) - Lesson 2

Indiana, His Good Stepmother

Materials: Abraham Lincoln: An Initial Biography, U.S. Atlas

→ RECAP

What have you learned about Abe Lincoln so far?

→ LOCATE

Map Resource: U.S. Atlas

1. p.14-15 Find Indiana. They are moving to another state. Which direction is Indiana from Kentucky?
2. p.91 What river makes up the border between Kentucky and Ohio? (Ohio River)

→ INTRO

How did people cross rivers in those days when there weren't many bridges? One way is a log raft ferry similar to the one in the picture.

∞ Image Link: Log raft ferry

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.15-26 "Summer days went" - "school start up."

- What kinds of hardships has Abe already faced when he was just a boy?
- What signs of hope were there in his life?

→ VIEW

Describe the kind of work that is going on in the picture on p.18-19. Would you enjoy doing that kind of work in order to live?

History: Grades 2-3 (U.S.)

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Term 1

WEEK 3 20m History: Grades 2-3 (U.S.) - Lesson 3

His Good Stepmother, The River and the Law

Materials: Abraham Lincoln: An Initial Biography, U.S. Atlas

→ INTRO

Why do you think so many people didn't know how to read back then? (few schools, books are hard to find, busy trying to survive) What advantage would someone have who knew how to read?

→ LOCATE

Map Resource: U.S. Atlas p.10-11

In the last chapter, we read about Abe and his family crossing the Ohio River. Now Abe is going to travel on the Mississippi. Trace the route from the Ohio River in Indiana to where the Mississippi River flows into the ocean. Do you know what city and state it flows through? (see p.14-15, New Orleans, Louisiana) You will find out more about that city in this chapter.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.26-35 "The winter Abe" - "about moving again." (You may want to stop throughout the reading to have your student narrate.)

- Why do you think Abe was so interested in reading?

→ VIEW

Image Link: Painting of a steamboat

WEEK 4 20m History: Grades 2-3 (U.S.) - Lesson 4

1830

Materials: Abraham Lincoln: An Initial Biography, U.S. Atlas

→ RECAP

What did you read about last time?

→ LOCATE

Map Resource: U.S. Atlas

1. p.14-15 Find Springfield, Illinois. Abe and his family are moving around that area.
2. In which direction are they traveling from Indiana?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.37-46 "February 12" - "mastered the rules."

- What do you think would be the hardest part of moving to a new area and starting again?
- What do you think Mr. Rutledge meant by "All he lacks is culture to reach a high place in life"?

→ VIEW

Image Link: Prairies of Illinois

• DEFINITIONS

unwieldy: not easy to manage or control (p.38)

yarns: a tall tale (p.38)

WEEK 5 20m History: Grades 2-3 (U.S.) - Lesson 5

1830, Mary Todd

Materials: Abraham Lincoln: An Initial Biography

→ INTRO

If you don't know how to do something or don't know much about a subject, what steps would you take to learn about it? When Abe didn't know about something, he read a book about it. And that was at a time

• EXTRA HELPING

Video Link: New Salem Historic Site

This video shows the New Salem historical site, where they reconstructed the town where Abe lived in the 1830s.

History: Grades 2-3 (U.S.)

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Term 1

when it was hard to find books. If you remember, he didn't even finish one year of formal school.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.46-56 "By spring" - "the Edwards' house."

- What stands out to you about the character of Abe?
- What characteristics seem to set him apart from other people?

WEEK 6 20m History: Grades 2-3 (U.S.) - Lesson 6

Mary Todd, Lawyer

 Materials: Abraham Lincoln: An Initial Biography

→ INTRO

When we think of famous people from the past, we often think that everything just went well for them and they went straight to the top. But as we can see with Lincoln, there were a lot of setbacks and discouragements along the way. Some people might give up, but Lincoln persevered.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.56-67 "November 4" - "his own state."

- Discuss some of the challenges and obstacles Abe faced and how he responded to them.

→ VIEW

∞ Image Link: Home of Lincoln and Mary

Abe and Mary Lincoln lived in this home from 1844 to 1861, when he became President. It is a historic site you can visit.

WEEK 7 20m History: Grades 2-3 (U.S.) - Lesson 7

President

 Materials: Abraham Lincoln: An Initial Biography

→ LOCATE

∞ Map Link: Map of U.S. in 1854

1. Look at the map key. What does orange mean? What does green mean?
2. Where are most of the states that allow slavery located? Why do you think that is the case?

We will read about a series of debates between Lincoln and Stephen Douglas that made Lincoln a household name across the country. Here is the question they were discussing: How do the new states decide if they will allow slavery or be a free state? These debates were very exciting for the people of Illinois. It was like a sporting event with crowds, music, and souvenirs.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.68-75 "One spring day" - "into the fog."

- What are some of the differences between Lincoln and Douglas?
- Do you think Douglas was surprised that Lincoln did so well in the debates? What do you think prepared him for these moments?

→ VIEW

1. ∞ Image Link: Statues of debate

These are life-size bronze statues of Lincoln and Douglas at their 8th debate in Alton, Illinois.

2. ∞ Image Link: Railsplitter painting

Did you catch the name they gave to Lincoln during his campaign—

• DEFINITIONS

secede: to separate from a nation or state and become independent

History: Grades 2-3 (U.S.)

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Term 1

Honest Abe, the Rail Splitter? Even though he was now a lawyer, he had split rails in his youth, and this image of him showing hard work and self-reliance was something many voters could relate to. This is a color reproduction of an 1858 painting.

WEEK 8 20m History: Grades 2-3 (U.S.) - Lesson 8

1861

 Materials: Abraham Lincoln: An Initial Biography, U.S. Atlas

→ INTRO

Do you think it would be fun to be a child in the White House? Two of President Lincoln's sons lived in the White House. William was 11, and Tad was 8, when their dad became President. Tad was known for his antics around the White House. He once discovered how to make all of the White House bells ring at the same time—much to the surprise of the entire staff and residents of the building!

→ LOCATE

 Map Resource: U.S. Atlas p.14-15

Find Washington, D.C. This is where Lincoln is going, now that he is President. Which direction is it from Springfield, Illinois?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.77-86 "February, 1861" - "the White House."

• Do you think being President of the U.S. is a hard or easy job? Why or why not?

→ VIEW

 Image Link: Confederate flag

This is the Confederate flag from 1861, housed in the Smithsonian.

• EXTRA HELPING

This is a short video about the beginning of the war at Fort Sumter.

 Video Link: Fort Sumter

WEEK 9 20m History: Grades 2-3 (U.S.) - Lesson 9

Emancipation

 Materials: Abraham Lincoln: An Initial Biography

→ INTRO

Abraham Lincoln is considered by many to be the greatest U.S. President. In this chapter, we will read about one of the things he did that makes him so admired.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

1. p.87-93 "Freeing of the" - "Pursuit of Happiness."

2. Read the first paragraph of the Emancipation Proclamation.

(Emancipation means freeing from bondage. Proclamation is an official statement or announcement made by the government.)

"That on the first day of January, in the year of our Lord one thousand eight hundred and sixty-three, all persons held as slaves within any State or designated part of a State, the people whereof shall then be in rebellion against the United States, shall be then, thenceforward, and forever free; and the Executive Government of the United States, including the military and naval authority thereof, will recognize and maintain the freedom of such persons, and will do no act or acts to repress such persons, or any of them, in any efforts they may make for their actual freedom."

• EXTRA HELPING

This chapter mentioned the telegraph office. This video tells the history of the telegraph.

 Video Link: History of the telegraph

History: Grades 2-3 (U.S.)

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Term 1

WEEK 10 20m History: Grades 2-3 (U.S.)- Lesson 10

At Gettysburg

Materials: Abraham Lincoln: An Initial Biography, U.S. Atlas

→ LOCATE

Map Resource: U.S. Atlas

1. p.14-15 Find Pennsylvania. Where is it in relation to Washington, D.C.?
2. p.47 This is a map of just Pennsylvania. Find Gettysburg, right over the southern border of the state. This area became a national cemetery for many soldiers who died, and it was the place where an important speech was given by President Lincoln called The Gettysburg Address. It begins with the famous lines, "Four score and seven years ago." Score means 20. So he is referring to 87 years ago when the United States became its own country in 1776.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.94-103 "Only one of" - "feel any easier."

- Is there anything we can do to honor those who sacrificed their lives for the freedom of our country?

→ VIEW

Image Link: Gettysburg National Military Park
This is where the battle took place.

• DEFINITIONS

orator: a person who makes speeches and is very good at making them (p.94)

WEEK 11 20m History: Grades 2-3 (U.S.)- Lesson 11

The Last Day

Materials: Abraham Lincoln: An Initial Biography

→ RECAP

What happened last time?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.104-109 "Friday, April 14," - "from the earth."

- What did you admire about President Lincoln?
- If you could ask him any questions, what would you ask?

→ VIEW

Image Link: Statue of Lincoln at the Lincoln Memorial in Washington, D.C.

• DEFINITIONS

malice: desire to cause pain, injury, or distress to another (p.105)

charity: love or kindness (p.105)

- **ILLUSTRATE** - Draw a scene from the story using watercolor or another medium such as chalk, pastels, or crayons.

WEEK 12 20m History: Grades 2-3 (U.S.)- Lesson 12

Exam Week

→ EXAMS

Answer question(s) related to course.

Questions will come from:
Abraham Lincoln: An Initial Biography



Term 2

WEEK 1 ☐ 20m History: Grades 2-3 (U.S.) - Lesson 13

The Book

☐ Materials: Escape By Night, U.S. Atlas

PREP: You may want to read this article and share some of the content. It talks about the church in Augusta, where President Woodrow Wilson's father pastored, and how the church was used for a hospital. It was the inspiration for this book.

∞ Article Link: First Presbyterian Church of Augusta

→ INTRO

This book is historical fiction, which means it is a fictional (not true) story set during real events from history. This takes place during the Civil War. The year was 1863. We don't always know what inspired an author to write a book, but in this case, we do know. Read the Author's Note on p.116-119.

→ LOCATE

☐ Map Resource: U.S. Atlas

1. p.14-15 Find Georgia. What part of the country is that? Is that a free state or a slave state?
2. p.65 Now find Augusta, Georgia. (D6) It is right across the border from what state? (South Carolina)

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.1 p.3-11

- How has the war changed daily life for families?

→ VIEW

See how the church and house look today. You can visit them.

∞ Image Links: First Presbyterian Church, Childhood Home of Woodrow Wilson

WEEK 2 ☐ 20m History: Grades 2-3 (U.S.) - Lesson 14

The One-Armed Soldier

☐ Materials: Escape By Night

→ RECAP

What happened in the first chapter?

→ INTRO

Do you know what kinds of transportation were available in the 1860s? (horses, carriages, steamboats, trains)

→ LOCATE

1. Look at the map at the beginning of the book. Find the First Presbyterian Church. It is on the corner of which streets?
2. Find Tommy's house. Where is it located?
3. Find the railroad depot. How many blocks from Tommy's house is it located?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.2 p.12-18

- Why do you think Tommy thought it was so important to find the man who lost the book?

History: Grades 2-3 (U.S.)

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Term 2

WEEK 3 20m History: Grades 2-3 (U.S.) - Lesson 15

A Commonplace Book

Materials: Escape By Night

→ RECAP

What happened in the last chapter?

→ INTRO

What is the title of this chapter? Do you know what that is? You will find out if you don't already know!

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.3 p.19-26

- Did you figure out what a commonplace book is? It is normally a book to put in quotes or poems from books you are reading, but in this case, the soldier also put in his own poem. You will probably use a commonplace book when you get older to record quotes and poems that you enjoy.

• DEFINITIONS

sovereign: in control over all creation (p.23)

WEEK 4 20m History: Grades 2-3 (U.S.) - Lesson 16

Big Steve, Blessed Are the Peacemakers

Materials: Escape By Night

→ RECAP

What happened in the last chapter?

→ INTRO

It is important to understand some of the terms used in this book. A Yankee is a term for someone from the North, while a Confederate soldier is someone from the South. The Union is the federal government and the loyal states, while the Confederacy was the group of southern states that broke away, or seceded.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.4-5 p.27-38

- Do you think Tommy might be right about the soldier being a Yankee?
- What would that mean if that were true?

• DEFINITIONS

chaplain: a religious leader who performs religious services for a military group (such as the army) or for a prison, hospital, etc. (p.32)

WEEK 5 20m History: Grades 2-3 (U.S.) - Lesson 17

Troubled, A Dream

Materials: Escape By Night

→ RECAP

Tell briefly what happened last time.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.6-7 p.39-53

- What do you think about Tommy's statement, "Some slaves are happy"? (p.53)
- What do you think Tommy will do now that he knows Red is a Yankee soldier?

• DEFINITIONS

refugee: someone who has been forced to leave a country because of war or for religious or political reasons (p.40)

• EXTRA HELPING

This video briefly tells about Robert E. Lee, who was mentioned in this chapter.

∞ **Video Link:** Robert E. Lee (stop at 1:50)

History: Grades 2-3 (U.S.)

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Term 2

WEEK 6 20m History: Grades 2-3 (U.S.)- Lesson 18

Great Power, The Deal

Materials: Escape By Night

→ RECAP

Tell briefly what happened last time.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.8-9 p.54-66

- What do you think Tommy should do? Why would it be a hard decision? What risks does Tommy face?

WEEK 7 20m History: Grades 2-3 (U.S.)- Lesson 19

Streams of Mercy, The Branded Hand

Materials: Escape By Night

→ RECAP

What did you read about last time?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.10-11 p.67-79

- A good quote for a commonplace book was mentioned at the beginning of chapter 10. "The heaviest burden in the world is a burden carried alone." What do you think that means?
- The SS branded on Jonathan Walker's hand was for slave stealer. Did you notice in the poem what John Greenleaf Whittier said SS stands for?
- Why do you think Tommy decided to help Red escape?

→ VIEW

∞ Image Link: Gravesite of Jonathan Walker

Jonathan Walker's gravesite is in Muskegon, Michigan. Did you notice what is on it?

WEEK 8 20m History: Grades 2-3 (U.S.)- Lesson 20

The Escape, Hunting a Slave

Materials: Escape By Night

→ RECAP

What did you read about last time?

→ INTRO

It is time for Tommy to execute his plan to help Red. Look at the map at the beginning of the book to trace his route. He needs to head towards Saint Paul's Episcopal church. Where is that located? What river is by the church?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.12-13 p.80-91

- Do you think Tommy is courageous, or do you have another word you would use to describe his actions?

History: Grades 2-3 (U.S.)

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Term 2

WEEK 9 20m History: Grades 2-3 (U.S.) - Lesson 21

The Diversion, The Jubilant Bell

Materials: Escape By Night, U.S. Atlas

→ RECAP

What did you read about last time?

→ LOCATE

Map Resource: U.S. Atlas

1. p.65 Find Augusta, Georgia, where Tommy lives. What river is on the border of the state? (Savannah River) What state is on the other side of the river? (South Carolina)
2. p.14-15 Find Ohio. That is where Red needs to go. Which direction is it from Georgia? (north)

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.14-15 p.92-104

- What kind of emotions do you think Tommy was feeling at the end of the chapter?
- What do you think his dad would say if he found out?

• DEFINITIONS

knell: a stroke or sound of a bell, especially when rung slowly (p.104)

WEEK 10 20m History: Grades 2-3 (U.S.) - Lesson 22

Farewell

Materials: Escape By Night

→ RECAP

What did you read about last time?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.16-Epilogue p.105-115

- How has Tommy changed from the beginning of the story to the end?
- What do you think about the statement that Tommy's dad made, "I admire a person with the courage to follow the leading of God, whether I agree or not"?

- ILLUSTRATE - Draw a scene from the story using watercolor or another medium such as chalk, pastels, or crayons.

WEEK 11 20m History: Grades 2-3 (U.S.) - Lesson 23

Catch-Up Day

→ CATCH UP

Use this time to catch up on lessons in this or another course, or explore Extra Helpings.

WEEK 12 20m History: Grades 2-3 (U.S.) - Lesson 24

Exam Week

→ EXAMS

Answer question(s) related to course.

Questions will come from:
Escape by Night

History: Grades 2-3 (U.S.)

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Term 3

WEEK 1 20m History: Grades 2-3 (U.S.)- Lesson 25

Materials: Buffalo Bird Girl, U.S. Atlas

→ INTRO

This book is based on the life of a woman who was a member of the Hidatsa people who lived in the Great Plains of North Dakota. Her name was Waheenee-wea, known as Buffalo Bird Woman, and she lived from 1839-1932. In the early 1900s, a man named Gilbert Wilson visited the reservation where Buffalo Bird Woman lived to write a book about her and tell the stories of the Hidatsa way of life that no longer existed. Her stories were written in two different books. The author of this book took those stories to create a book for children so they can learn what life was like for that tribe in the 1800s.

→ LOCATE

Map Resource: U.S. Atlas, map in book

1. p.14-15 Find North Dakota. What borders that state? (Canada to the north, Minnesota to the east, South Dakota to the south, and Montana to the west)
2. Now look at the map at the beginning of the book.
 - a. Find the Great Plains. How would you describe that kind of area? Plains are large, flat areas of land that have few changes in elevation.
 - b. What rivers are flowing through this area? (Missouri, Little Missouri, Knife, Heart)
 - c. Read the key at the top of the page and find those places on the map.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

1. p.2-15 "I was born" - "and then doing."
 2. Go back and look at the pictures and read the captions.
- Read the quote at the beginning of the book that begins with "This earth is alive..." What did you notice about what the Hidatsa believe? How is that different from what you believe?
 - How do the Hidatsa use the resources of the earth in their daily lives?

→ VIEW

Image Link: Photo of Buffalo Bird Woman

You may want to print this out and use it for your wall timeline.

• DEFINITIONS

smallpox: serious disease that causes fever and a rash, boils on the skin, and often death (p.3)

immunity: a condition of being able to resist a particular disease (p.3)

alliance: a union between people, groups, countries, etc.: a relationship in which people agree to work together (p.5)

WEEK 2 20m History: Grades 2-3 (U.S.)- Lesson 26

Materials: Buffalo Bird Girl

→ RECAP

What do you know about Buffalo Bird girl so far?

→ LOCATE

Turn to the map at the beginning of the book. Find Fort Berthold on the map. It was a trading post for white traders and natives. Do you know what kind of items were traded? Do you remember where Buffalo Bird Girl lived? (Like-a-Fishhook Village) How do you think traders got to that area? (steamship up the river) You will find out more about trading in today's reading.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

1. p.16-25 "Friendly tribes such" - "into the night."
 2. Go back to look at the pictures and read the captions.
- Were any of the children's activities similar to what you might play?
 - How are the lives of the Hidatsa children different from yours?

History: Grades 2-3 (U.S.)

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 3

WEEK 3 20m History: Grades 2-3 (U.S.) - Lesson 27

Materials: Buffalo Bird Girl, U.S. Atlas

→ RECAP

What do you remember about the last reading?

→ LOCATE

Map Resource: U.S. Atlas p.10-11

Find North Dakota. What climate zone is it? (cold and wet) It has long, cold winters and warm, short summers. How do you think that would affect the Hidatsa?

→ INTRO

Imagine you didn't have electricity or grocery stores. What kind of things would you have to figure out in order to have food?

The Hidatsa had methods for growing, harvesting, and storing food.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.26-37 "And then came" - "of the seasons."

- How did routines and daily life change according to the seasons?

WEEK 4 20m History: Grades 2-3 (U.S.) - Lesson 28

Materials: Buffalo Bird Girl

→ RECAP

What do you remember about the last reading?

→ INTRO

By the late 1800s, the way of life for the Hidatsa and other tribes across the United States had changed forever. They were forced to live on designated lands called reservations. There are approximately 326 Indian land areas in the U.S., administered as federal Indian reservations. The largest is the 16 million-acre Navajo Nation Reservation located in Arizona, New Mexico, and Utah. The smallest is a 1.32-acre parcel in California where the Pit River Tribe's cemetery is located. Many of the smaller reservations are less than 1,000 acres. Now, 70% of Native Americans don't live on reservations.

→ LOCATE

This map shows the Indian reservations in the U.S. Can you find Fort Berthold in North Dakota?

∞ Map Link: Indian Lands in the U.S.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

1. p.38-40 "I am an old" - "of new life."

2. Author's Note p.42-44: My Story, The Hidatsa Story, The Traditional Way, Today and the Future

- What is different about your life and the life of Buffalo Bird Girl?
- If you could have asked Buffalo Bird Girl a question about her life, what would you ask her?

- **ILLUSTRATE** - Draw a scene from the story using watercolor or another medium such as chalk, pastels, or crayons.

WEEK 5 20m History: Grades 2-3 (U.S.) - Lesson 29

Materials: Coolies; globe or wall map; U.S. Atlas

PREP: You may want to read the Author's Note on p.38 to have more context for the story. You want to number the pages starting with p.1 as the beginning of the story.

• DEFINITIONS

kowtow: to kneel and touch the forehead to the ground in token of homage, worship, or deep respect (p.1)

ancestors: one from whom a person is descended (p.1)

History: Grades 2-3 (U.S.)

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 3

→ INTRO

We might not travel by horses and carriages anymore, but there is one mode of transportation that we still use just like the people in the 1800s. What do you think that is? (train) There are still train tracks all across the country that take goods and people from east to west and north to south. Have you thought about how those tracks were laid down? We will read about some of the people who came a very long way to do that hard, dangerous work.

→ LOCATE

📄 Map Resource: globe or wall map, U.S. Atlas

1. Find China. How do you get to the U.S. from there? (on a ship across the Pacific Ocean) What part of the country would you sail to from China? (west coast) We will read about people from China who came all the way to the U.S. to help build the railroad.
2. Using the U.S. Atlas p.128-129, find the San Francisco Bay. That is where the two brothers in the story docked after months at sea.
3. Find Sacramento. This is where the brothers started their work.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

1. Read the narrative. p.1-14 "Every year PawPaw" - "he would say."
2. Go back and look at the pictures and discuss what you see.

- Why did people call America "the land of opportunity"?
- Why would it be hard to move to a new country?

∞ Image Link: Transcontinental railroad

You may want to print this out and use it for your wall timeline.

★ TEACHER NOTE

You may want to discuss the practice mentioned on p.1. China has a grand tradition of ancestral worship that has been carried forward through the ages. It is based on the belief that the souls of the deceased have power and influence over the lives of the living.

WEEK 6 📅 20m History: Grades 2-3 (U.S.) - Lesson 30

📄 Materials: Coolies

→ RECAP

What do you remember about the last reading?

→ MAP QUESTIONS

∞ Image Link: Map of Transcontinental Railroad

Look at the map of the transcontinental railroad. "Trans" means across. It is going across the continent.

1. Where does it begin in the west? (Sacramento, California)
2. Where does it begin in the east? (Omaha, Nebraska)
3. Where will they meet in the middle? (Promontory, Utah)
4. What challenging geographical features do they need to cross? (mountains, rivers, desert)

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

1. Read the narrative. p.15-26 "The brothers slept" - "by his side."
2. Go back and look at the pictures and discuss what you see.

- What do you think would have been the most difficult part of working on the railroad?
- Why do you think the Chinese workers were not treated fairly?

WEEK 7 📅 20m History: Grades 2-3 (U.S.) - Lesson 31

📄 Materials: Coolies

→ RECAP

What do you remember about the last reading?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

1. Read the narrative. p.27-37 "Then, in the late" - "could I forget?"

History: Grades 2-3 (U.S.)

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 3

2. Go back and look at the pictures and discuss what you see.

- Why do you think the brothers decided to stay in America?

→ **VIEW (OPTIONAL, IF THERE IS TIME)**

∞ Video Link: Transcontinental Railroad and the American West

WEEK 8 20m History: Grades 2-3 (U.S.) - Lesson 32

📄 Materials: Dandelions, U.S. Atlas

→ **INTRO**

In the 1800s, many people decided to head west and begin a new life. They put all their belongings in a covered wagon, known as a prairie schooner, ready for adventure. This book tells you about Zoe and her family as they head out west. Imagine what life was like for people at that time. Even though things were very different, they still had the same desires as anyone—freedom, success, and happiness.

→ **LOCATE**

📄 Map Resource: U.S. Atlas

1. p.84-85 Find Illinois. That is where Zoe and her family came from.
2. Now find Nebraska. During the time of the story, it was not yet a state; it was a territory. That is where they were going. It might not seem that far to us, but when you are riding in a wagon, and there are no paved roads, it is a hard journey.

→ **READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS**

p.1-14 "We came to" - "water kegs refilled."

- Why do you think Papa seemed excited when they reached their land, but Mama seemed sad?

→ **VIEW**

∞ Image Link: Sod house

How was a sod house built? Many of the pioneer settlers made large, heavy bricks of layers of sod. One brick could weigh about 50 pounds. They were about two feet long. The bricks blended together and formed sturdy walls. But these houses' walls curved instead of being straight up and down. Like an igloo made of snow bricks, sod houses were a bit wider at the bottom so they could hold all the weight of the bricks. Building a house from sod bricks was hard work and time-consuming, but it didn't cost anything. (from wildercompanion.com)

WEEK 9 20m History: Grades 2-3 (U.S.) - Lesson 33

📄 Materials: Dandelions

→ **RECAP**

What did you read about last time?

→ **READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS**

p.15-26 "Mr. Svenson gave" - "help me choose."

- How was life for pioneer families different from your life?
- What would be especially hard about moving to a new place like the Kansas territory?

→ **VIEW**

What kind of chores do you think pioneer children helped with? With no electricity and running water, chores were a lot harder to do. You will learn how children helped with the laundry.

∞ Video Link: Pioneer Children's Chores (just watch 1:15-4:50)

Term 3

WEEK 10

20m History: Grades 2-3 (U.S.) - Lesson 34

 Materials: Dandelions

→ RECAP

What do you remember about the last reading?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.27-42 "He spoke some" - "Mama said."

- Why did Zoe think the dandelions would be a good present for Mom?

→ VIEW

There were always chores for the family to do. Now let's watch the section about cleaning the rugs, gardening, and chopping wood.

∞ Video Link: Pioneer Children's Chores (11:07-14:05)

WEEK 11

20m History: Grades 2-3 (U.S.) - Lesson 35

Catch-Up Day

→ CATCH UP

Use this time to catch up on lessons in this or another course, or explore Extra Helpings.

WEEK 12

20m History: Grades 2-3 (U.S.) - Lesson 36

Exam Week

→ EXAMS

Answer question(s) related to course.

Questions will come from:

Buffalo Girl, Coolies, and Dandelions.

History: Grades 2-3 (U.S.)

Examination

- Term 1** · Abraham Lincoln: An Initial Biography: Tell all you know about the story of Abraham Lincoln's journey from his childhood to becoming president during the Civil War.
- Term 2** · Escape by Night: How did Tommy meet Red, and how did their friendship change Tommy's views of the Civil War and slavery?
- Term 3** · Buffalo Girl, Coolies and Dandelions: Tell how the people described in these books experienced life in America in the 1800s.